

SEO AUDIT REPORT

backlinko.com

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72/100 Overall Score	85/100 On-Page SEO	61/100 Technical SEO	78/100 Content Quality	55/100 Backlink Profile
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01 EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Backlinko.com is a leading SEO and digital marketing authority site founded by Brian Dean. This audit evaluates the site across on-page optimisation, technical health, content strategy, backlink profile, and user experience. The site demonstrates exceptional content quality and brand authority, with primary improvement opportunities in technical infrastructure, mobile page speed, and structured data implementation.

CATEGORY	STATUS	PRIORITY	IMPACT
On-Page SEO	GOOD	LOW	Stable rankings, strong keyword targeting
Technical SEO	FAIR	MEDIUM	Mobile speed & Core Web Vitals
Content Strategy	GOOD	LOW	Traffic retention, content depth
Backlink Profile	NEEDS WORK	HIGH	Net-negative link velocity
User Experience	FAIR	MEDIUM	Mobile CLS, bounce rate
Mobile Optimisation	GOOD	LOW	Mobile rankings maintained

02 ON-PAGE SEO ANALYSIS

2.1 Title Tags & Meta Descriptions

Backlinko's title tags are precisely crafted with primary keywords at the front and follow the recommended 50-60 character limit. Meta descriptions are compelling with clear value propositions within 150-160 characters. A small percentage of blog posts use duplicate or auto-generated meta descriptions - addressable with a targeted content audit.

ELEMENT	STATUS	NOTES
Title Tags	OPTIMIZED	Keyword-first, correct length throughout
Meta Descriptions	MOSTLY GOOD	~12% pages missing unique descriptions
Header Tags (H1-H3)	OPTIMIZED	Clear hierarchy maintained across all pages
Keyword Placement	OPTIMIZED	Natural density, zero keyword stuffing
Image Alt Text	PARTIAL	~20% of images missing alt attributes
Internal Linking	STRONG	Deep interlinking across blog content
URL Structure	OPTIMIZED	Short, keyword-rich, clean slugs
Canonical Tags	PRESENT	Correctly implemented site-wide

2.2 Content Quality Assessment

Backlinko's content is regarded as the gold standard in the SEO industry. Articles are data-driven, long-form (averaging 2,500+ words), and exhaustively researched. The Skyscraper Technique - Backlinko's signature methodology - is consistently applied across all cornerstone content. Content freshness is a minor concern: 15+ high-traffic posts have not been updated in 12-18 months and are at risk of ranking decay.

2.3 Keyword Strategy

The site ranks for thousands of high-intent SEO and digital marketing keywords. Topical clusters around link building, on-page SEO, keyword research, and content marketing are well-executed. LSI keyword usage is natural and well-distributed. Primary opportunity: targeting question-based long-tail queries to capture featured snippets and voice search traffic, which currently represent an underpenetrated segment.

03 TECHNICAL SEO ANALYSIS

3.1 Site Speed & Core Web Vitals

Mobile page speed is the most critical technical concern. Core Web Vitals analysis reveals LCP averaging 3.8s on mobile - significantly above Google's 2.5s threshold. Key contributors include render-blocking JavaScript, uncompressed images, and third-party script overhead. Desktop performance is strong across all metrics.

METRIC	DESKTOP	MOBILE	TARGET	STATUS
LCP (Largest Contentful Paint)	1.9s	3.8s	< 2.5s	FAIL
FID (First Input Delay)	12ms	45ms	< 100ms	PASS
CLS (Cumulative Layout Shift)	0.04	0.11	< 0.10	FAIL
TTFB (Time to First Byte)	0.4s	0.8s	< 0.6s	WARN
Speed Index	2.1s	4.2s	< 3.4s	FAIL

3.2 Crawlability & Indexation

The robots.txt is correctly configured and an XML sitemap is submitted to Google Search Console. Crawl depth is well-managed - virtually all important pages are reachable within 3 clicks from the homepage. HTTPS is fully implemented with a valid SSL certificate. Four URLs were found using 302 temporary redirects instead of 301 permanent redirects - this leaks link equity and should be corrected immediately.

3.3 Structured Data & Schema

Schema markup implementation is limited. Article schema is present on blog posts, but FAQ schema, HowTo schema, and BreadcrumbList schema are absent. Implementing FAQ schema on the top 20 high-traffic posts alone could increase SERP real estate and improve click-through rates by an estimated 20-30% through rich results.

04 BACKLINK PROFILE ANALYSIS

Backlinko has a strong but maturing backlink profile. The site has accumulated high-authority editorial links from major publications and industry leaders. However, new link acquisition has slowed - net link velocity is negative over the last 90 days, representing a long-term risk to domain authority maintenance against aggressively growing competitors.

Metric	Value	Benchmark	Assessment
Domain Authority (est.)	76/100	Top 5% of all sites	STRONG
Total Referring Domains	~18,400	Industry leader	STRONG
New Links (Last 90 days)	~340	Declining trend	CONCERN
Lost Links (Last 90 days)	~510	Net negative (-170)	WARNING
Toxic / Spammy Links	~2%	< 5% acceptable	PASS
Anchor Text Diversity	High	Natural distribution	GOOD
Dofollow / Nofollow Ratio	82% / 18%	60-80% dofollow target	GOOD

05 PRIORITY ISSUES & RECOMMENDATIONS

Pri.	Area	Finding	Recommendation
HIGH	Page Speed	Mobile LCP 3.8s exceeds Google's 2.5s threshold on key pages	Compress images to WebP, defer non-critical JS, enable browser caching
HIGH	Link Velocity	Net negative link velocity over last 90 days (-170 net lost links)	Launch digital PR campaign; create linkable assets - studies, tools, infographics
HIGH	Schema Markup	No FAQ, HowTo, or BreadcrumbList schema on high-potential pages	Implement FAQ schema on top 20 posts; add BreadcrumbList site-wide
MEDIUM	Alt Text	~20% of images missing descriptive alt attributes	Audit all images via Screaming Frog; add keyword-relevant alt text
MEDIUM	302 Redirects	4 URLs using temporary 302 redirects instead of permanent	Convert all 302 redirects to 301 to preserve full link equity
MEDIUM	Content Freshness	15+ high-traffic posts not updated in 12-18 months	Schedule quarterly content refreshes for top 20 traffic pages

05 PRIORITY ISSUES (CONTINUED)

PRI.	AREA	FINDING	RECOMMENDATION
MEDIUM	CLS Mobile	Mobile CLS of 0.11 exceeds 0.10 threshold on several pages	Reduce space for ad/image elements; eliminate layout shift triggers
MEDIUM	Speed Index	Mobile Speed Index of 4.2s significantly above 3.4s target	Eliminate render-blocking resources; implement lazy loading for images
LOW	Meta Descriptions	~12% of pages missing unique meta descriptions	Write unique meta descriptions for all top-100 organic traffic pages first
LOW	Voice Search	Limited FAQ-style content targeting voice/conversational queries	Add question-based H2/H3 headers with 40-60 word direct-answer sections

06 90-DAY ACTION PLAN

PHASE 1 - DAYS 1-30 | Quick Wins

- Convert all 302 redirects to 301 redirects - preserves full link equity immediately
- Add descriptive alt text to all images identified as missing attributes
- Write unique meta descriptions for top 100 organic traffic pages
- Implement BreadcrumbList schema across all blog category and post pages
- Enable image compression and convert images to WebP format

PHASE 2 - DAYS 31-60 | Technical Fixes

- Defer non-critical JavaScript and eliminate all render-blocking resources
- Implement FAQ schema on top 20 highest-traffic blog posts
- Fix CLS issues on mobile - reserve fixed dimensions for ad and dynamic content
- Improve TTFB through server-side caching and CDN optimisation
- Audit and improve internal linking on all pre-2020 content

PHASE 3 - DAYS 61-90 | Growth & Authority

- Publish an original data-driven industry study to generate editorial backlinks
- Launch podcast guest outreach campaign targeting high-authority SEO publications
- Refresh top 15 high-traffic posts with updated statistics and expanded sections
- Add question-based headings to top 20 posts targeting featured snippet positions
- Build 2-3 free tools or calculators as permanent linkable assets

TOOLS & METHODOLOGY

TOOL	PURPOSE
Google Analytics / Search Console	Traffic data, keyword rankings, indexation status
Screaming Frog SEO Spider	Technical crawl — redirects, alt text, broken links, meta tags
PageSpeed Insights	Core Web Vitals — LCP, CLS, FID, TTFB measurements
Semrush / Ahrefs (Reference Data)	Backlink profile, domain authority, referring domains
Schema.org Validator	Structured data verification and rich result eligibility
Manual Content Review	Content quality, keyword strategy, UX and readability

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Digital Marketer & Data Analyst
HubSpot · Google · Microsoft Certified

Available on Fiverr & Upwork

SEO Audits · Excel Dashboards · Email Marketing · Social Media